

LINKS GOLF MAJOR

July 16–19, 2026 · Southport, England · \$1,000 Bankroll · fully deployed (6 outright + 5 top-10 props)

● ROUND 1 — LATE · THU JUL 16 · UPDATED 7:15 PM UK (1:15 PM CT)

Jackson Suber makes it official: a 5-under 65 is in the clubhouse and leads the 154th Open — the eagle at 17 the difference, one clear of **Dan Brown and Sungjae Im at −4**. The story for our card is still **Morikawa, −3 through 14** — two off the lead deep into the round, hitting it exactly like the 28-to-1 we paid for. **Koepka was even par through 10 at last check**, grinding to keep the 🌐 longshot in range. The clubhouse picture for the rest: **Scheffler's 68 (−2) still sits three back** — quietly excellent given last week's missed cut — DeChambeau in at −3, and **Rahm and Fleetwood both signed for 69 (−1)**. **Fitzpatrick remains the grind at +2**, stuck in the same birdie-free group as McIlroy through the turn. Bottom line after (almost) one lap: five of six outright winners within five of the lead, Morikawa closest — full R1 wrap once the last groups are in.

156 players

FIELD · 4 ROUNDS

Royal Birkdale

FIRST OPEN HERE SINCE
2017

Scheffler

DEFENDING CHAMPION

R1 LIVE

SINCE 6:35 AM THU

🚩 HOW THIS CARD WORKS — TWO-PHASE BUILD

Golf majors settle over four days against a 156-man field — even the favorite is only ~15% to win, so an outright card is a **basket of longshots by nature**. Phase 1: \$600 across six outright winners, odds locked at build. Phase 2 (deployed Wednesday, before the first tee): **\$400 across five top-10 finish props** on our basket players — the higher-probability side of golf betting, where a top-10 cashes when our guy merely contends rather than has to win outright.

OUTRIGHT BOARD (DK / CONSENSUS AT BUILD)

Scottie Scheffler (def. champ)	+450	Rory McIlroy	+750
Jon Rahm	+1600	Tommy Fleetwood (Southport)	+1600
Xander Schauffele ('24 champ)	+1600	Matt Fitzpatrick	+2000
Cameron Young	+2500	Collin Morikawa ('21 champ)	+2800
Viktor Hovland	+3000	Brooks Koepka	+5000

THE ANGLES

SCHEFFLER +450 · THE ANCHOR

WORLD NO. 1 · DEFENDING OPEN CHAMPION

- ▶ Best player alive, though winless in 13 starts — the price got longer than his true chance
- ▶ Opened +400, drifted to +450; markets over-punish "droughts" for elite iron players
- ▶ Links golf rewards flushed irons + flighted wedges — his exact profile

Est. win: 18% vs ~15% market — the rare positive-EV favorite

FLEETWOOD +1600 · THE HOMETOWN STORY WITH TEETH

BORN IN SOUTHPORT — BIRKDALE IS LITERALLY HIS HOME COURSE

- ▶ Grew up playing Royal Birkdale; no player knows these dunes better
- ▶ Elite links pedigree: multiple top-fives in Opens, best ball-striking season of his career
- ▶ The narrative price and the golf price agree for once

Est. win: 7% vs 5.9% market

THE ENGLISH CONTINGENT

FITZPATRICK +2000 · HOME MAJOR MOTIVATION

- ▶ Fitzpatrick: three wins this season, best year of his career, home country major
- ▶ Knock: 94th in strokes-gained putting — links greens neutralize that gap
- ▶ Rahm +1600: two-time major champ, near-misses at both 2026 majors, built for wind

Rahm est. 7% · Fitzpatrick est. 5.5% — both above market

MORIKAWA + THE LONGSHOT

PROVEN OPEN WINNERS AT LONG PRICES

- ▶ Morikawa +2800: 2021 Open champion, just shot a Sunday 61 at Travelers
- ▶ Koepka +5000: five majors, big-game hunter, priced at career-long odds
- ▶ Majors are where Koepka's focus shows up — 50/1 is a stats-vs-narrative bet

Morikawa est. 4.5% · Koepka est. 2.5% — the 🌐 longshot lives here

\$1,000 BANKROLL ALLOCATION

TOTAL BUDGET

\$1,000

\$600 on 6 outright + \$400 on 5 top-10 props · fully deployed

BASKET COVERAGE

~44%

chance one of our six lifts the Claret Jug

★ PHASE 1 · OUTRIGHT WINNER BASKET (MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE — MAX ONE CASHES)

PICK	ODDS	STAKE	EST. WIN	TO WIN	TYPE
1 · Scottie Scheffler Defending champ · drought discount on the best player alive	+450	\$200	18% mkt 15%	+\$900.00	ANCHOR
2 · Jon Rahm Two majors · near-misses all season · wind player	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
3 · Tommy Fleetwood Southport native — Birkdale is his home course	+1600	\$100	7% mkt 5.9%	+\$1,600.00	HOME TURF
4 · Matt Fitzpatrick 3 wins this season · English home major	+2000	\$80	5.5% mkt 4.8%	+\$1,600.00	VALUE
5 · Collin Morikawa 2021 Open champ · Sunday 61 at Travelers	+2800	\$70	4.5% mkt 3.4%	+\$1,960.00	VALUE
6 · 🌐 Brooks Koepka The longshot — 5 majors, career-long price, big-game DNA	+5000	\$50	2.5% mkt 2%	+\$2,500.00	LONGSHOT

PHASE 2 · TOP-10 PROPS · DEPLOYED WED JUL 15 · \$400

7 · Scottie Scheffler — Top 10 World No. 1 / +620 favorite · safest of the basket	-146	\$120	62% mkt 59%	+\$82.19	ANCHOR
8 · Tommy Fleetwood — Top 10 Southport native · Birkdale is his home links	+158	\$90	44% mkt 39%	+\$142.20	VALUE
9 · Jon Rahm — Top 10 Elite wind player · value vs the field	+172	\$80	42% mkt 37%	+\$137.60	VALUE
10 · Matt Fitzpatrick — Top 10 English · six straight cuts made at The Open	+164	\$70	42% mkt 38%	+\$114.80	VALUE
11 · Collin Morikawa — Top 10 2021 Open champ · elite ballstriker for links	+280	\$40	30% mkt 26%	+\$112.00	VALUE

Portfolio note. The six outright winners are mutually exclusive — at most one cashes, but any one of them pays for the entire card several times over (Scheffler +\$900 minimum, Koepka +\$2,500 maximum). Combined coverage: ~44% that one of ours wins the Jug. The \$400 Phase 2 deployment — five top-10 props across the basket — is the higher-probability hedge: a top-10 cashes when our guy contends, not only when he lifts the Jug. Scheffler's is near-even money; the other four carry plus-money value. **McIlroy +750 is our biggest deliberate fade** — playing too infrequently this year to trust at half Fleetwood's price.

ALLOCATION SUMMARY

\$1,000

FULLY DEPLOYED

11

BETS (6 + 5 PROPS)

~44%

BASKET COVERAGE

+\$2,500

BEST SINGLE PAYOUT

Fictitious \$1,000 bankroll test — no real money wagered. For entertainment purposes only.

Odds: DraftKings / consensus boards + Golf Digest reporting, locked at build (Sun Jul 12). Phase 2 props added Wednesday Jul 15.

Settlement Sunday Jul 19 · tracked in betting_tracker.xlsx, tab "The Open".